Speak out 3RD EDITION

B2+
UNIT 8 TEST | Version A

Part A • Grammar, Vocabulary and How to …

GRAMMAR

1 Choose the correct words to complete the sentences.

1 **Although** / **That said** we don't have much time, I'm sure we can finish the game.
2 **However** / **While** I haven't got much experience, I'm a quick learner.
3 **Admittedly** / **Even though** there isn't a pool at the hotel, we can use the public one in the town centre.
4 There are good reasons for Katrina to go away to university**. At the same time** / **Though**, I can see why she doesn't want to leave her family.
5 The journey there took ages. The return journey was a lot quicker **although** / **though**.
6 Roberta's been ill for the last few days. **Although** / **However**, she seems to be getting better now.
7 **Admittedly** / **While**, I don't know how to snowboard, but it can't be that hard, can it?
8 **Clever that** / **Clever though** he is, he still finds it difficult to get on with people.
9 **Interesting as that** / **Interesting though** is, I haven't got time to stop and chat about it.
10 **True though that** / **True that though** may be, I don't see how it affects us.

/10

2 Choose the correct option (a, b or c) to complete the sentences.

1 She will ___ more than five thousand miles by the time she completes her journey.
a cycle **b** be cycling **c** have cycled
2 I'm sure the weather ___ better tomorrow. Don't worry.
a is being **b** will be **c** will be being
3 We probably won't ___ in this house this time next year because it's too small already.
a be living **b** be lived **c** have lived
4 We ___ to order pizzas for dinner. Do you want one?
a 'll **b** 'll be **c** 're going
5 By 2100, temperatures will ___ by at least 1.5 degrees if we don't reduce greenhouse gases.
a be risen **b** have risen **c** be rising
6 My parents will already ___ when we get home, so we'll need to be quiet.
a sleep **b** have slept **c** be sleeping
7 The competition winner will ___ at the end of the month.
a be announced **b** been announced **c** be announcing
8 He will have ___ the team for five years this November.
a managing **b** been managing **c** be managing
9 She ___ her friends tonight, but I could be wrong.
a sees **b** might be seeing **c** will be seeing
10 A cure for the disease might not have ___ in our lifetime. We should be prepared for that possibility.
a been found **b** been finding **c** found

/10

VOCABULARY

3 Choose the correct words to complete the sentences.

1 I hate the fact that some people take more than they need. It's pure **curfew** / **greed**.
2 We need to fight against **oppression** / **idealism** in all its forms because no one should be treated unfairly.
3 Nobody's coming to get you. This idea of yours is just **paradise** / **paranoia**.
4 If the government continues to ignore the people, there's bound to be **justice** / **social unrest**.
5 They moved to the countryside because they wanted to experience some **surveillance** / **tranquillity**.

/5

4 Complete the sentences with the words in the box. There are two words you do not need.

activate **convert** **eliminate** **emit** **monitor** **recharge** **revolutionise**

1 My neighbour uses a food-sharing app which helps to _____ food waste on a local level.
2 Imagine a coat that can _____ the air pollution around us and alert us when levels are unsafe.
3 You can use this device to _____ dollars into other currencies, like euros or pounds.
4 This invention will _____ the way we communicate. It's going to change everything.
5 I couldn't find anywhere to _____ my car with electricity so I was unable to continue my journey.

/5

5 Match the descriptions in the box with what is being talked about.

energy-efficient **hand-held** **hazardous** **recyclable** **state-of-the-art**

1 'This is a device which can be carried around with you.' _____
2 'Be careful with this material because it's dangerous.' _____
3 'This washing machine uses less water and electricity than other models.' _____
4 'This car has the most up-to-date onboard computer.' _____
5 'This packaging can be reused to make more packaging.' _____

/5

© 2023 Pearson **PHOTOCOPIABLE**

6 Complete the sentences with words for machines.

1 The boxes are placed on the **c** _ _ _ _ _ _ **r** which carries them to the end of the production line.
2 The factory is expected to be fully **a** _ _ _ _ _ _ _ **d** by the end of the year.
3 Some online retailers have been trying out **d** _ _ _ _ _ _ **y b** _ _ **s** to distribute their parcels.
4 In the future, there may be a **s** _ _ _ _ _ **e** which will take passengers to the moon on a regular basis.
5 You need to **s** _ _ **n** your finger before you can use the phone.

/5

HOW TO …

7 Complete the conversation with the words and phrases in the box.

all different	**blow**	**cost-effective**	**expenditure**
frankly	**one way**	**overdraft**	**see what**
side of the coin	**steady job**		

A: I've been thinking we should get a new car. The old one's a bit worn out now.
B: [1]_____, I don't think we can afford it at the moment. Our household [2]_____ is way too high.
A: I can [3]_____ you're saying, but it might be more [4]_____ in the long-run because we'd save money on fuel.
B: But you'd have to [5]_____ all your salary on a new car. We're talking about thousands of pounds. Not only that, but you haven't even got a(n) [6]_____. You're on a short-term contract.
A: I guess that's [7]_____ of looking at it, but we could ask the bank to give us a(n) [8]_____.
B: Yes, but the other [9]_____ is that we'd have to pay the money back. It's not a solution.
A: I wouldn't worry about that myself. But I guess we're [10]_____.

/10

Total: /50

© 2023 Pearson **PHOTOCOPIABLE**

Part B • Listening, Reading and Writing

LISTENING

1 [Audio UT8.01] Listen to a radio discussion about the relationship between science, technology and science fiction. Match each statement (1–5) with one of the science fiction films or series, *Star Trek* (ST), *The Matrix* (TM) or *Minority Report* (MR). The films or series may be used more than once.

1 It's central concept has been accepted by some scientists using probability theories. ___
2 It's been proven that the main concept of this film can be carried out by computers. ___
3 It was thought to have inspired a hand-held device for talking to people. ___
4 It generated moral questions which are also relevant in real life. ___
5 It featured a method for instantly moving objects from one place to another. ___

/5

2 [Audio UT8.01] Listen again. Complete the sentences with a word or short phrase.

1 The presenter was impressed with the way the *Star Trek* _____ were able to forecast the future.
2 *Star Trek* features a number of fictional _____ which have become real over time.
3 Felix thinks the future imagined in *Star Trek* reflected the _____ of people at the time it was written.
4 Surveillance cameras appeared in a _____ novel called *1984*.
5 The Transporter in *Star Trek* permitted people to travel to a planet's _____ in no time at all.
6 According to Felix, the Transporter was another name for what me might call a _____.
7 Felix thinks it is unlikely that humans will be able to move around the _____ spontaneously.
8 In a film starring Keanu Reeves, the energy of people is _____ by a giant computer.
9 In *Minority Report*, three people are used to _____ illegal activity which has not yet taken place.
10 The computer programs which can predict crime in real life are described as _____.

/10

READING

3 Read an extract from a story. Number the events (A–E) in the order they are mentioned.

A The narrator is aware of people ignoring him. ___
B The narrator makes a decision to change his life. ___
C The narrator sets off on a journey to a village. ___
D The narrator listens to the sounds of animals. ___
E The narrator bumps into someone he knows. ___

/5

As always, the valley is bathed in the soft orange light cast by the first rays of sunshine. I breath in deeply and take in the pleasant morning air. As I walk towards the village, I'm struck once again by the timeless beauty of the valley. The green fields either side of the path stretch off into the distance, punctuated by the occasional oak tree or flock of sheep, and I can't help smiling to myself as I stride along. No longer do I carry that sense of fear which used to be a permanent feature of my life. It's as if I've got no cares in the world, although I know this is only an illusion. After all, my avatar could be deactivated at any time.

Approaching the village, I bump into Ned who's steering his horse and cart, loaded up with fruit and veg for the market. Their colours are almost too vivid to be true and their form is perfect. 'Morning Harry,' Ned calls out cheerfully, 'How are you this glorious morning?' Before I get a chance to reply, he starts chattering away about the solar-powered generator that's going to be installed in the village. According to him, it's going to revolutionise village life, providing power for the well and the clock in the square. 'There might even be enough power left over for electric lights,' he adds optimistically. 'The last thing we need here is a revolution,' I say with a chuckle. At the same time, I can't help remembering the social unrest I'd experienced in my past life.

Before going our separate ways, Ned throws me a shiny red apple from his cart. Waving goodbye, I take a large bite and carry on towards the village. It feels like another perfect day in Somerton, until I glance up at the small hill which keeps guard over the village. Long ago I decided it was better not to focus on the tall metal structure sitting on top of the hill, its single red light flashing on and off. It was there in my past life as well, the red eye blinking at us as if to say, 'I'm watching you.' As soon as it catches my eye, I'm immediately transported back to the past. Gone is the sleepy atmosphere which I've grown used to, replaced by the whirring of delivery bots as they speed past. Neighbours hurry by without so much as a glance, unable to shift their eyes from their smartphones. In fact, the only things aware of anyone else's existence are the surveillance cameras on every corner.

That was the beginning of the end really, although I only became aware of it when the birds disappeared from the rooftops. When I was a kid, you could always hear them singing their morning songs, but, over time, the music became quieter and quieter. After the bees went as well, it didn't take long for the food chains to break down. Admittedly, I'd never been a fan of fruit and veg, but I became uneasy when they started disappearing from the supermarket shelves. After that, everything spiralled out of control at breakneck speed. The government had no choice but to impose strict laws in an attempt to control theft and violence. The surveillance cameras monitored our every movement, and curfews ensured the streets were deserted at night. Dystopia had always seemed to belong in science fiction novels, but here I was, experiencing it first-hand. That's why uploading my personal biodata to the system wasn't a hard decision to make. There was nothing left for me there.

Coming back to 'reality', the red eye carries on blinking sleepily, but no longer is it threatening me. Instead, it's telling me that everything is OK. The birds aren't going to disappear and nor will Ned with his cart of fruit and vegetables. The alternative reality system is still active and my avatar will get to live another day in paradise.

© 2023 Pearson **PHOTOCOPIABLE**

4 Read the extract again. Are the statements True (T) or False (F)?

1 The narrator has never realised how beautiful the valley is before. **T** / **F**
2 The narrator understands that his life is not as perfect as it seems. **T** / **F**
3 Ned believes a piece of technology will have a minor impact on life in the village. **T** / **F**
4 The narrator's conversation with Ned reminds him of a difficult time in the past. **T** / **F**
5 The narrator describes someone standing on the small hill next to the village. **T** / **F**
6 The narrator starts reminiscing about the past when he looks at the metal structure. **T** / **F**
7 The narrator first realised something bad was happening when he couldn't see any birds. **T** / **F**
8 A lack of fruit and vegetables in the supermarket hadn't concerned the narrator. **T** / **F**
9 The narrator recalls how inhabitants had to stay indoors when it was dark. **T** / **F**
10 At the end of the extract, the narrator is worried that he won't be able to continue living in the village. **T** / **F**

/10

WRITING

5 Match the topic sentences for an opinion essay (1–5) with the examples and ideas (a–e).

1 We have failed to deal with the most serious threats to the planet. ___
2 Large corporations have continued to invest in fossil fuels. ___
3 Emissions from cars and trucks have also seen consistent growth. ___
4 We must also consider the damage being caused by marine pollution. ___
5 We should not give up hope just yet. ___

a While investment in oil and coal has decreased slightly, investment in gas has continued to rise since the 1960s.
b It is thought that there are hundreds of thousands of tonnes of plastic waste floating around in our oceans.
c We have a strong survival instinct and a history of overcoming challenges.
d The most serious are changing land use, climate change and marine pollution.
e This is despite the availability of non-polluting electric vehicles.

/5

6 Read the essay question below and write your response.

> 'By 2050 most jobs will be automated and most people will be out of work.'
>
> To what extent do you agree with this opinion and what alternatives to work might there be?

Write 200–260 words.

/15

Total: /50

Part C • Speaking

SPEAKING

1 Describe and compare the pictures showing people doing experiments.
Why might the people be doing experiments in these situations?





/15

2 Answer your partner's question.

/5

3 Listen to your partner talk about their pictures.
Ask: To what extent might using this technology have revolutionised or changed the people's lives?

Total: /20

© 2023 Pearson **PHOTOCOPIABLE**